



NO. 2 OF 16

Avery Lark

THE RESIDENT SINGER

“Every night at the Blue Lantern ends with your song. Tonight, someone wrote a different ending.”

FOR AVERY LARK'S EYES ONLY

CORE CHARACTER

BOOKLET · 4 PAGES

WHAT TO WEAR · PICK EITHER

SUIT STYLE

A midnight-blue tuxedo with satin lapels, a silver bow tie and a sparkly lapel pin.

MASK: White swan

DRESS STYLE

A sequined drop-waist dress, a long string of pearls and a feathered headband.

Keep this booklet closed until the party. Turn the page only when the Inspector tells everyone to read “Before the game”.

PAGE 2

Before the game: who you are and what you know.

PAGE 3

Rounds 1–3: read each one only when the Inspector says so.

PAGE 4

Your notes and the suspect quick list.

Before the game

You have sung at the Blue Lantern every Friday and Saturday for six years. At 11:50 pm tonight you began your closing number, “Midnight Moon”, on the bandstand under the spotlight, with Frankie Dade’s band behind you. You wear a white swan mask.

YOUR SECRET

At 9:30 Gus called you into his office and told you your contract ends this month: a big-city singer is coming to replace you. You said, “You’ll regret this, Gus,” loud enough for the cloakroom to hear. At 11:20 you slipped into the service corridor behind the bandstand to cry where nobody could see, and you were back on stage for the 11:30 Last Waltz.

You are innocent

From 11:50 until the lights went out at 11:58 you were on the bandstand in the spotlight, singing. The whole room was looking at you.

HOW TO PLAY TONIGHT

- ◆ Read each round only when the Inspector starts it. Do what it says while you mingle.
- ◆ You may keep your secret until your booklet tells you to share it. You may not lie about anything printed on an evidence card.
- ◆ In Round 1, swap the rumour on your Rumor card with as many guests as you can.
- ◆ Stuck? Ask someone a question, or go and study the evidence table.

PLAYING AVERY

Your manner: Glamorous, warm and a little dramatic. Hum a few bars when you are nervous, call everyone “darling” and remember you are the star of this room.

Rounds 1–3

Round 1



Read only when the Inspector starts Round 1

Act shaken: you were mid-song when the room went dark. Share what you saw from the bandstand at 11:55: a guest in a silver fox mask handed Gus his gold-rimmed coupe at the champagne tower. Keep the corridor to yourself for now; if anyone mentions the contract, brush it off.

Round 2



Read only when the Inspector starts Round 2

Admit the contract news if asked, with dignity. Share something else you saw from the stage: at about 11:57 the silver fox walked away from the tower and through the service corridor door, just before the lights went out. When the lights came back, there was no silver fox anywhere in the ballroom.

Round 3



Read only when the Inspector starts Round 3

If anyone mentions the corridor, admit you were there at 11:20, alone and upset. You never touched the fuse box: you were back on stage for the Last Waltz at 11:30, and singing at 11:58. Ask who else had a reason to fear Gus's midnight announcement.

Notes & suspects

YOUR NOTES: WHO SEEMS NERVOUS? WHOSE STORY HAS CHANGED?

BEFORE YOU VOTE

At the end, everyone fills in a ballot: who, how and why, plus the clue that convinced you.

Suspect quick list (public information only)

NAME	ROLE	TALK OF THE PARTY
Remy Quill	The Art Dealer	Sold Gus the seascapes in his gallery
Avery Lark	The Resident Singer	Contract about to be cancelled by Gus
Jordan Pierce	The Club Partner	Would lose everything if the club was sold
Sidney Hart	Gus's Ward and Heir	Named in Gus's new will
Morgan Bellamy	Owner of The Gilded Owl	Gus's business rival
Frankie Dade	The Bandleader	Owes Gus a large sum of money
Charlie Ashby	The Society Columnist	Wore the silver fox mask; had a column about Gus
Dana Rook	The Caterer	In charge of the champagne tower
Leslie Croft	Gus's Lawyer	Knows exactly what the new will says
Billie Sable	The Coat-Check Attendant	Saw who came and went from the cloakroom
Robin Vale	The Aviator	Lost a fortune in Gus's air-mail company
Jesse Monroe	The Photographer	Took the 11:55 photograph
Kit Haverford	The Shipping Heir	Broke off an engagement to Gus
Taylor Moss	The Stage Magician	Knows how to make the lights go out
Emery Fontaine	The Dance Instructor	Not on the dance floor at 11:58
Marion Kettle	The Club Chef	Keeps the greenhouse key in the kitchen
Inspector Sloane Whitaker	The host	Running the investigation
Augustus "Gus" Whitlock	The victim	Owner of the Blue Lantern Club